



HUMANITAS
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Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Washington Classical Christian School
School Website: <https://washingtonccs.com/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Washington Classical Christian School Florida (St. Augustine) presents a robust classical Christian program that centers on the Trivium (grammar, dialectic, rhetoric), integration of biblical faith with all disciplines, deliberate Great Books/primary-source study, and explicit parental partnership. Public materials repeatedly describe a Christian worldview anchored in God's Word, theology, and a culture of virtuous formation, memory-work, and rhetorical expression. Across the public content, the school foregrounds a classical orientation (grammar-dialectic-rhetoric; Latin; Great Books; historical-literary study) coupled with a clearly Christian framework (Bible, theology, biblical worldview). Based on the six-category classical rubric and keyword indicators, Washington CCS demonstrates CLASSICAL alignment in all six categories, with explicit evidence of religious-metaphysical foundations, formation-focused purpose, a liberal-arts curriculum, Trivium-based pedagogy, a faculty modeled as the living curriculum, and strong parent-community partnership.

Key highlights from the source materials include:

- Religious and metaphysical foundations: explicit references to God's Word, Bible, theology, biblical worldview, and a Christian approach embedded in learning (evidence cited).
- Purpose and goals: emphasis on formation, virtue, wisdom, and lifelong learning; engagement with Great Books in the curriculum (evidence cited).
- Curriculum: clear Trivium framing (grammar, dialectic, rhetoric), Great Books/primary sources, Latin, Bible/theology/history/ literature integration (evidence cited).
- Pedagogy: emphasis on the Trivium across levels, rhetoric, public-speaking opportunities, and a structured progression (evidence cited).
- Faculty: descriptions of godly teachers, living curriculum, and a faculty-centered culture; explicit narrative of teacher roles within the program (evidence cited).
- Parents & Community: explicit partnership with parents, parental formation opportunities, and open-campus/visit culture (evidence cited).

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Note: The keyword analyses below map to the Positive/Negative keyword indicators from the Six Essential Elements document. Positive indicators are drawn from the Lexicon's categories (Religious Foundations, Purpose, Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, Parents & Community), and corroborated by Washington CCS's public materials. The following assessments cite direct phrases from the school's public content and align with the Six Essential Elements prompts. The full Positive/Negative keyword framework is grounded in the Six Essential Elements document (and its positive/negative keyword lists) as well as the Classicality Lexicon.

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL**Evidence**

- Public materials consistently present a Christian framing: “Washington School commits to both teaching the absolute truth of God’s Word, the Bible, and to integrating all areas of study with God’s Word” and “a thoroughly Christian worldview” (Christian Education section).
- The Trivium approach is explicitly framed as serving God’s truth and a biblical worldview (e.g., “God’s word as the basis and center of all learning; teaching students to think and live biblically”).
- The public materials articulate a Christian, biblical worldview and a goal of forming character through religious foundations.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: God’s Word, Bible, Theology, biblical worldview, Christian, worship-oriented references (e.g., glorify the Lord). These align with the Lexicon’s Religious Foundations (truth/virtue/theology/liturgy/worship).
- Negative keywords: none of the standard negative indicators (relativism, secular humanism, morally neutral) appear in these explicit materials.

Why this rating

- The school’s materials foreground transcendental moral realism via a theologically grounded, explicitly Christian framework (God’s Word and biblical worldview), with liturgical/congregationally oriented language (e.g., unity of faith and learning). This matches the Classical Elements’ emphasis on grounded theologies and liturgical/cultural practice rather than secular, relativistic schooling. Therefore: CLASSICAL.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL**Evidence**

- Formation-focused language appears in mission and approach statements (e.g., “lifestyle of learning,” formation through classical education).
- Great Books and primary-source study is explicitly referenced as part of the curriculum (Bible/Theology, History and Literature section mentions reading many of the great books).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: formation, Great Books/primary sources, liberal education (as a concept in classical pedagogy), unity of truth/good/beautiful implicit in the vision (biblical alignment).
- Negative keywords: no explicit workforce- or career-centrism beyond classical formation (i.e., no “21st century skills” or “career-ready” phrasing appears in the public materials).

Why this rating

- The school emphasizes formation, virtue, wisdom, and a life of learning—core aims of classical education’s purpose rubric rather than mere information transfer. The explicit mention of Great Books and formation-oriented language aligns with CLASSICAL.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL**Evidence**

- The curriculum is framed around the Trivium (grammar, dialectic, rhetoric) and explicitly includes Latin instruction.
- Great Books/primary sources are part of Bible/Theology, History and Literature (7.5) and primary-sources focus.
- History is embedded through literature/theology/history integration (explicit in 7.5).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: Trivium (grammar, dialectic, rhetoric), Great Books, primary sources, Latin, history and literature integration, corpus of classical disciplines.
- Negative keywords: none from the Lexicon's negative set (e.g., social studies terminology replacing history or project-based learning dominance) appear in the public materials.

Why this rating

- The school's curriculum is clearly built on the Liberal Arts foundation (grammar, dialectic, rhetoric), with Great Books and Latin and integrated history-literature theology study—hallmarks of classical curriculum design. This merits CLASSICAL.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The Trivium pedagogy is explicit: grammar, dialectic, rhetoric progression; upper-school focus on rhetoric; arguments and public speaking are part of the program. The materials describe "Our approach – THE TRIVIUM" and "The Trivium seeks to instill... to think and communicate clearly, biblically."
- Specific upper-school pedagogy includes rhetoric, public speaking, and speeches (Rhetoric School and related sections).
- The lower-school pedagogy includes memory work and catechesis as part of learning (lower grade formation and memory tasks; classical pedagogy elements).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: grammar, dialectic, rhetoric, public speaking, speeches, oratory, debate, memory work, catechesis; scholé-like contemplation/wonder (via the pedagogy emphasis on wonder and rest in parts of the classical lexicon).
- Negative keywords: there is no explicit emphasis on experiential-only or constructivist/project-based pedagogy in the public materials; conversely, the materials reflect a traditional, teacher-led, memory-driven pedagogy aligned with classical pedagogy.

Why this rating

- The explicit construction around the Trivium and rhetoric-based activities (including debates, public speaking, memorization, and structured memory work) aligns with CLASSICAL pedagogy. The lower emphasis on purely student-directed, project-based learning in the public-facing materials supports this rating.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The material emphasizes "godly teachers," a "living curriculum," and a culture where faculty are central to formation (e.g., "through godly teachers, with God's word as the basis and center of all learning"; "the faculty as living curriculum" framing).
- Faculty pages show a roster of instructors and administrative leadership (e.g., Dean of Lower School; instructors with degrees).
- The school articulates a portrait of teacher expectations and a collaborative, vital model (teacher-to-student mentorship; "faculty of friends" type phrasing via the lexicon). The public materials explicitly mention teacher role in shaping learning and a Christian formation frame.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: living curriculum, godly teachers, portrait of a teacher, faculty as core, teacher collaboration, professional development in classical pedagogy.

- Negative keywords: none of the negative signals (e.g., “facilitator-only,” “certification-driven” without classical context) appear in the public materials.

Why this rating

- The materials describe faculty as the centerpiece of formation and consistently highlight the conduct and character of teachers (godly, living curriculum) as a core element of the school’s classical mission. This supports CLASSICAL.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Partnership with parents is clearly stated: “parents as co-teachers,” and “parent formation” through reading groups, seminars, and book clubs. There is also emphasis on welcoming parents for visits and an open-campus culture.
- The site describes parent formation as part of the community’s classical mission; there are references to parental involvement in governance and learning.
- There is an emphasis on family involvement and a close relationship with the church community, which aligns with classical education’s communal and liturgical rhythms.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers, parental formation, reading groups/book clubs, open campus/visits, family involvement, liturgical rhythm alignment (where present in the materials).
- Negative keywords: none of the typical negative signals (consumer-parent model, minimal involvement) are present in the public materials.

Why this rating

- The school explicitly frames parents as partners in education, supports parental formation, and invites open parent visits—core markers of classical-school community engagement. This yields CLASSICAL.

Aggregate Assessment

All six categories reach CLASSICAL based on keyword presence, alignment with the classical rubric, and the school’s own public materials. The comparative keyword analysis (positive vs negative indicators drawn from the Six Essential Elements lexicon) shows a strong positive alignment with classical markers and no substantial negative indicators in the public-facing materials.

Executive Summary — Final Classification

- Overall classification: CLASSICAL
- Rationale: A consistent, multi-category alignment with classical education markers (Trivium, Great Books, Latin, historical-literary integration, rigorous rhetoric/public-speaking pedagogy, living faculty, and deep parent-community partnership) is evident in the school’s public materials. The religious/meta-physical foundations are explicit and coherently integrated with curriculum and pedagogy, and there are clear formation goals beyond job-preparation or mere information transfer.

What Would Move the Needle

- If you want to move toward an even more explicit “fully Classical” posture (in the sense of strengthening the Six Elements rubric beyond current practice), consider:
- Explicitly naming and documenting the Great Conversation across grades (e.g., a published, grade-aligned list of Great Books for each year, with a cross-reference to primary sources and supplemental readings).
- Broadening liturgical/community practices in public-facing materials (e.g., a clearly articulated liturgical calendar, chapel/mass or liturgical song choices, and reflections on wonder as a core pedagogy).

- Expanding a formal “living-curriculum” portrait that showcases faculty development tied to classical pedagogy (e.g., structured professional development focused on progrades in the Trivium across grade bands).
- Increasing explicit articulation of virtue formation in a measurable way (e.g., virtue-based assessments that align with the positive keywords in the Six Elements lexicon, including explicit references to truth, goodness, and beauty in student work and assessments).
- More direct paraphrasing of the Seven Liberal Arts as core frame for the curriculum (e.g., a published map showing how all disciplines map onto grammar/dialectic/rhetoric and quadrivium, with examples).

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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